



Thinking About My Future Goals

Adolescent Global Resource Curriculum

Ages 19 and Older, Year 2

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Lesson 1: Life Timeline

Objectives

At the end of this lesson, students will be able to use critical thinking skills that they have learned to evaluate personal goals and ambitions.

Assets

Developmental assets used in this lesson include the following:

- Self-esteem (38) – initial activity, tutor-led discussion
- Sense of purpose (39) – initial activity, tutor-led discussion
- Planning and decision making (32) – closing activity, tutor-led discussion
- Interpersonal competence (33) – learning activity, group discussion

Requirements

This lesson requires the following:

- **Time:** 45 minutes
- **Materials / equipment:** Paper/pencil or chalk/chalkboard

Activities

Explanation of lesson plan

- Psalm 139:14-16
- Life timeline

Initial activities (about 10 minutes)

Step 1. Read Psalm 139:13-16

13 For you created my inmost being; you knit me together in my mother's womb. **14** I praise you because I am fearfully and wonderfully made; your works are wonderful, I know that full well. **15** My frame was not hidden from you when I was made in the secret place. When I was woven together in the depths of the earth, **16** your eyes saw my unformed body. All the days ordained for me were written in your book before one of them came to be.

Step 2. Ask the students to explain how long God has known them and how long he will be with them (since before they were in the womb, or forever).

Learning activities (about 30 minutes)

Step 1. Have the students work on a timeline of important events in their lives. (There is no right or wrong way to do this.) Show them an example if you wish.

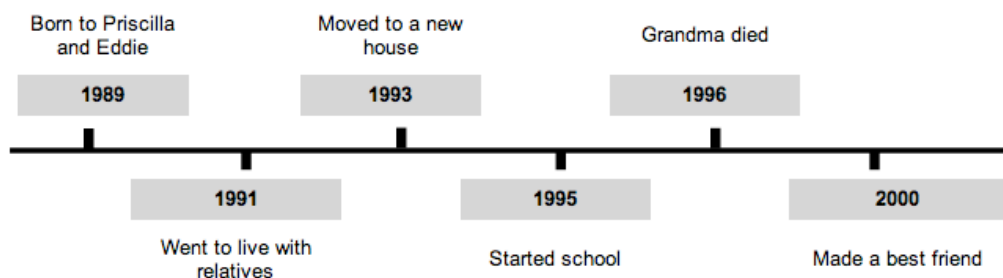


Figure 1. Example Timeline

TIP: This timeline does not have to be done using years; it could be done with ages or simply be a list of events in order without any dates, years, or ages.

Step 2. Depending on available time and group size, give the students time to share in small groups of two or three or as a whole group.

Closing activities (about 5 minutes)

Step 1. Ask the students to take a minute to think about how these events have made them who they are today.

Step 2. Have them think about one goal that they might have for the future. (They can write this down or just think about it.)

Lesson 2: Goals

Objectives

At the end of this lesson, students will be able to use the critical thinking skills that they have learned to evaluate personal goals and ambitions.

Assets

Developmental assets used in this lesson include the following:

- Positive view of personal future (40) – all activities
- Planning and decision making (32) – learning activity, tutor-led discussion, closing activity

Requirements

This lesson requires the following:

- **Time:** 45 minutes
- **Materials / equipment:**
 - Paper/pencil or chalk/chalkboard
 - If available, copies of goal sheets (see Appendix 1 – Goal Planning Chart)
 - If available, relaxing music for the visualization

Activities

Explanation of lesson plan

- Jeremiah 29:11
- Visualization journey
- Goals

Initial activities (about 10 minutes)

Step 1. Remind the students that the last time they met, they worked on a life timeline.

Step 2. Remind them that they also thought of one goal for themselves in the future. (Let them share again, if they wish.)

Step 3. Read Jeremiah 29:11 from the Bible.

11 “For I know the plans I have for you,” declares the LORD, “plans to prosper you and not to harm you, plans to give you hope and a future.”

Learning activities (about 25 minutes)

Step 1. Show the students an example of how to fill out the chart. You may want to pick one of the boxes, for example, Character Goals, and tell them what you would put in the box.

Example: "I would put honesty in character goals. I feel that it is important that people can trust me and know that I am always truthful."

Step 2. Have the students write down personal goals. They can use the following chart as a guide.

TIP: Use the chart to get ideas; students don't have to fill in all of the blanks.

Type of Goals	My Goals
Career goals (what I would like to do)	
Character goals (how I want to be)	
Friend goals (what kind of friends I want)	
Marriage/children/self (whether to get married and have children; what kind of person I would like to marry)	
Christian walk (how I can have a relationship with God and how I can deepen that relationship)	
Helping others (how I can help others)	
Health goals (what I need to do to stay healthy)	
Personal goals (what I will do for myself)	

TIP: Have the students keep these goals to use with the next lesson. They will have time to complete them then, if needed.

Closing activities (about 5 minutes)

Step 1. Read Jeremiah 29:11 again from the Bible.

11 "For I know the plans I have for you," declares the LORD, "plans to prosper you and not to harm you, plans to give you hope and a future."

Step 2. Tell the students that part of having goals is planning how you will achieve them.

Lesson 3: What Do I Want?

Objectives

At the end of this lesson, students will be able to do the following:

- Use the critical thinking skills that they have learned to evaluate personal goals and ambitions.
- Apply Christian worldview principles to real-life problems and their solutions.

Assets

Developmental assets used in this lesson include the following:

- Planning and decision making (32) – learning activity
- Sense of purpose (39) – learning activity, closing activity
- Positive view of personal future (40) – initial activity, tutor-led discussion

Requirements

This lesson requires the following:

- **Time:** 45 minutes
- **Materials / equipment:** Paper/pencil or chalk/chalkboard

Activities

Explanation of lesson plan

- Read John 14:27 and Joshua 1:9
- Answer future questions
- Revisit goals
- Read Psalm 139:23-24

Initial activities (about 10 minutes)

Step 1. Read John 14:27 from the Bible.

27 Peace I leave with you; my peace I give you. I do not give to you as the world gives. Do not let your hearts be troubled and do not be afraid.

Step 2. Read Joshua 1:9 from the Bible.

9 “Have I not commanded you? Be strong and courageous. Do not be terrified; do not be discouraged, for the LORD your God will be with you wherever you go.”

Learning activities (about 25 minutes)

Step 1. Have the students complete these phrases.

- At the end of my life, I want my spouse to say...
- At the end of my life, I want my children to say...
- At the end of my life, I want my friends to say...
- At the end of my life, I want the Lord to say...

TIP: These statements require a lot of thought. It will be hard for some students to consider some of these topics, so give them plenty of time.

Step 2. As a whole group, if possible, ask the students to share at least one thought or answer. They do not have to share, but encourage them to do so.

Step 3. Have the students look at their goals from the last meeting. Now ask them, “How does new information about how you want people to view you fit with your current goals? Do you need to revise any goals or add to your list?”

Step 4. Give them time to revise their goal sheets.

Closing activities (about 5 minutes)

Read Psalm 139:23-24 from the Bible.

23 Search me, O God, and know my heart; test me and know my anxious thoughts.

24 See if there is any offensive way in me, and lead me in the way everlasting.

Lesson 4: Obstacles/Solutions

Objectives

At the end of this lesson, students will be able to use the critical thinking skills that they have learned to evaluate personal goals and ambitions and to identify obstacles to achieving those goals.

Assets

Developmental assets used in this lesson include the following:

- Planning and decision making (32) – learning activity, tutor-led discussion
- Sense of purpose (39) – initial and closing activities
- Positive view of personal future (40) – initial activity
- Service to others (9) – closing activity

Requirements

This lesson requires the following:

- **Time:** 45 minutes
- **Materials / equipment:**
 - Paper/pencil or chalk/chalkboard
 - If possible, goals that were written during Lesson 3
 - If available, copies of the obstacle/solution chart (see Appendix 2 – Goals / Obstacles Chart)

Activities

Explanation of lesson plan

- Proverbs 3:5-6
- Obstacle/solution chart
- Phillipians 4:6-7 and Jeremiah 18:6

Initial activities (about 5 minutes)

Step 1. Read Proverbs 3:5-6 from the Bible.

5 Trust in the LORD with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding; 6 in all your ways acknowledge him, and he will make your paths straight.

Step 2. Remind the students that God will direct their lives, open doors, and remove obstacles if it is His will.

Learning activities (about 25 minutes)

- Step 1.** Have the students take a few minutes to look at the goals that they wrote for themselves.
- Step 2.** Ask them to get into groups of two or three.
- Step 3.** Have each person share a goal and talk about anything that might keep them from reaching that goal.
- Step 4.** After everyone has had a chance to share, ask the group to talk about the goals and responses and to help each other come up with possible solutions.
- Step 5.** Have each student work individually on his or her obstacle chart.

Goals	Obstacles	Solutions/Ideas

Closing activities (about 10 minutes)

- Step 1.** Remind the students that it is an important part of God's plan that we serve or help one another. Tell them that it is sometimes good to talk with others about solutions because we cannot always see ways to overcome our own obstacles, and others might have good suggestions or insight.
- Step 2.** Read Phillipians 4:6-7 from the Bible.
- 6 Do not be anxious about anything, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. 7 And the peace of God, which transcends all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus.
- Step 3.** Remind the students that God will always be with them to help and guide them.
- Step 4.** Read Jeremiah 18:6.
- 6 "O house of Israel, can I not do with you as this potter does?" declares the LORD. "Like clay in the hand of the potter, so are you in my hand, O house of Israel."

Tips for Success

Consider these tips to ensure success:

- When students are giving ideas or thoughts, be sure to listen to all of them and do not be tempted to give your own opinions. Make sure everyone is heard.
- Try to create a safe environment where students can share their ideas and solutions without being ridiculed for their thoughts.
- An important part of learning in the unit comes from working in teams. Try to make sure that students are in groups that they will and can work with.
- Students will likely have very strong opinions, considering some of these topics. Once again, help the students to understand that these are THINKING exercises. They are being taught to think in constructive ways and to listen and look at other people's opinions and points of view whether they agree or disagree.

Assessment

Test your knowledge by doing the following activities.

Table 1. Assessment Activities

Question	Answer

Evaluation

Evaluate the learning process/lesson plan through the following activities.

Table 2. Evaluation Activities

Question	Answer

Additional Comments:

Bibliography

Gargiulo, Terrence L. *Once Upon A Time – Using Story-Based Activities to Develop Breakthrough Communication Skills*. New York: Wiley, 2007.

Appendix 1 – Goal Planning Chart

Use this chart with Lesson 2.

Type of Goals	My Goals
Career goals (what I would like to do)	
Character goals (how I want to be)	
Friend goals (what kind of friends I want)	
Marriage/children/self (whether to get married and have children; what kind of person I would like to marry)	
Christian walk (how I can have a relationship with God and how I can deepen that relationship)	
Helping others (how I can help others)	
Health goals (what I need to do to stay healthy)	
Personal goals (what I will do for myself)	

TIP: Keep this goal chart to use with the next lesson. Students will have time to finish this activity during the next lesson.

Appendix 2 – Goals / Obstacles Chart

Use this chart with Lesson 4.

Goals	Obstacles	Solutions/Ideas